

Silicon Defect Physics

March 20, 2026

Defects in silicon can introduce electronic states in the bandgap. These states act as recombination and trapping centers. A simple phenomenological lifetime model is

$$\frac{1}{\tau_{\text{eff}}} = \frac{1}{\tau_0} + K_{\tau} N_D.$$

As the defect density increases, carrier lifetime decreases.